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The Banner Swap in the Wind

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A Black Banners Adventure for Fate's Edge (no gunpowder)

Adventure Overview

@ll@ **Tier:** IIIII

Length: 23 sessions

Theme: Banner politics, village defense, condotta manipulation

Hook: A Vilikari village caught between two rival banner companies offers the party a chance

to play the companies against each other for the village's survival.

Setup: The Village of Saltmere

Saltmere sits in a strategic valley where two trade routes converge. The **Iron Lanterns** (siege specialists who promise “no fire in hospitals”) and the **Thornwrights** (sappers/roadcutters who price bridges by the breath) hold *conflicting charters* to secure the valley. Village elders approach the PCs to manipulate both banners into terms that spare Saltmere.

Saltmere at a Glance

tem **Assets:** Winter granaries, shrinehospital (old stone), river ford, timberyards, way-market green. tem **Strings:** Ledger of Small Kindnesses (debts owed), fordright witness-stone, belltoken set (for parley). tem **Timers:** *Granary Seizure* [4], *Shrine Fire Rumors* [4], *Village Panic* [6].

The Companies What They Want (concrete aims)

section*Iron Lanterns Siege Specialists
Captain Thorne Ironwright (methodical, honorbound) seeks:

tem **Garrison Charter:** permanent *win-*

ter garrison with stipend. tem **Sanctuary Credit:** public recognition of Lantern hospital rites. tem **Bridge Priority:** stamp rights if siege breaks a crossing.

Quartermaster Bray wants predictable *Payday* and *rations*. *section*Thornwrights* **Sappers** **RoadCutters** **Captain “Cut” Marrick** (reckless innovator) seeks:

tem **Demolition Writs:** license to *fire-set wedge* old footings. tem **Reconstruction Fees:** toll schedule until *the bridge is paid*. tem **Exclusive Road Works:** first refusal on all valley roads.

Engineer Tessa Chain wants materials and *no audits*.

Props Handouts (printables)

tem **Charter Excerpt Cards (indexsized):** one for each company with *said* and *meant* lines. tem **Bell Dawn Rite Card:** the threebell sanctuary text. tem **Articles of the Camp Sheet:** quick examples (below).

Articles of the Camp (examples violations)

p0.44p0.5 rule **Article (exemplar text) Typical Violation / Evidence**
rule No open flame nor firesetting within twenty paces of a sanctuary. Char streaks, heatstress in stone, pitch jars and braziers in shrine yard.
Take no road you will not defend. Abandoned picket, unpaid tolls during raid, missing watch roster.
Record both said and meant; do not trade on ambiguity. Conflicting orders, unsigned addenda, missing witnesses.
No seizure of granaries without Bowl (fairness) first. Grain carts diverted without ledger entry; stamped but unsigned receipts.
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Article Cite (mechanical): Citing a relevant Article under witness grants **Position +1** for that parley; presenting *material evidence* adds **DV 1**.

Session Structure Pacing

Act I Council (4560 min). Frame crisis, place timers, hand out charter cards.

Interlude Orders (1015 min). Each PC may take *1 BetweenScene Order: Scout, Audit, Canvas*, or *Secure Proof*. Resolve with a single roll; deliver leads as cards.

Act II Manipulations (6090 min). Run Parley, Debts, False Orders, and/or *Forgery MiniScore* (below).

Act III Crisis Charter Endgame (4575 min). Roll Allegiances in Flux once midtalks; resolve a *Synthesis*, *Gambit*, or *Third Way*.

Investigation Beats (choose order)

tem **Charter Analysis** (*Wits+Lore* or *Diplomacy (Broker) DV 3*): Overlaps with *different end terms* (*first frost* vs. *bridge is paid*). Note *witness gaps*. tem **Ledger of Small Kindnesses** (*Wits+Investigation DV 4*): Concrete debts: Lanterns owe *sanctuary upkeep*; Thornwrights owe *bridge toll arrears*. tem **Scout Reports** (*Wits+Survey DV 3*): Sightings: mantlets staged; *leverframes*, *pitchkettles*, and *ropesaws* positioned at old footings.

BetweenScene Order Option: PCs can push any one beat offscreen for speed.

Forged Ledger, Real Stakes (miniscore)

Make *The False Ledger* an active heist in four steps; three successes needed before 2 SB are generated.

tem **Materials** (*Craft+Wits* or *Subterfuge DV 3*): Acquire proper paper, stamps, inks. *SB: Shortfall add Watermark Test later.* tem **Language** (*Lore+Wits DV 4*): Match charter idiom; fill *said/meant*. *SB: Anachronism adds DV +1 to Delivery.* tem **Witness Seal** (*Diplomacy+Presence DV 3*): Coax a minor clerk/bellwitness to “remember” witnessing. *SB: Loose Tongue Rumor [2].* tem **Delivery** (*Subterfuge+Stealth DV 4* or *Performance+Presence DV 4*): Plant or present without cross-exam. *On hit:* target unit *Withdraws 1 ring* or suffers *Cohesion +1*. *On miss: False Orders [4]* flips on PCs.

Bell Dawn Parley (setpiece)

Presence+Sway DV 4 under witness; *Wits+Diplomacy* may Assist. Ring three bells; both captains attend. If *Ledger Debt* is presented, choose 1:

tem Impose *No Seizure of Granaries [4]* jointly. tem Establish *Single Banner Hour* (only one company shows colors in town per day).

Condotta Flip (Allegiances in Flux)

Roll 1d6 at scene starts or on a PC trigger; interpret via their play: ,label=.

tem **Charter Challenge:** Accuse Thornwrights of storing *pitchkettles* and *resin jars* in shrine bounds; Lantern inquiry (Position +1 to press). tem **Debt Reminder:** Thornwrights fluster; Captain orders an audit (their Payday +1 if unfunded). tem **False Orders:** Conflicting movements begin (*False Orders [4]* ticks). tem **Broker’s Market:** Exclusive lane offers narrow claims (gain *Bridge Peace [4]* on hit). tem **Village Leverage:** Threaten

provisioning the rival (on partial: *Village Panic +1*). tem **Article Violation:** Formal accusation under witness; force parley or lose face.

Charter Synthesis Workshop (make it tactile)

Draft a new charter by choosing **2 clauses** (and 1 *cost*) from each list; then roll *Broker+Petition DV 5* with Position based on choices made.

Lantern Clauses (pick 2)

tem Winter Garrison capped at *20 spears* and *no levy*. tem Sanctuary care funded by *toll tithe* (1 in 20 breaths). tem Bridge priority stamps only *during declared emergencies*.

Thornwright Clauses (pick 2)

tem Toll schedule sunsets after *two harvests* or *Bridge Paid [6]*. tem **Firesetting** limited to *downriver footings*; *no flame* within sanctuary radius. tem First refusal on *road repairs* for one year.

Costs (pick 1)

tem Village owes *Indemnity [4]* if raids spike. tem PCs pledge *Witness Duty* (be present for violations; Reputation at stake). tem Market day tithe funds a neutral *Broker's Bell*.

On hit: both patrons accept; gain *Broker's Favor* x2. *On partial:* one accepts; the other demands *Indemnity [4]*. *On miss:* *Political Pressure [4]* enters play.

Endgame Options

section*The Village Gambit *Lore+Diplomacy DV 4* under witness. Invoke *Ledger Law*: old debts narrow present claims. If upheld, both banners pull to outer rings; village keeps core.

section*The Third Way *Command+Presence DV 4*. Joint defense against a common threat; start *Shared Defense [6]*. On fill, both banners leave with honor; village gains *Watch Rights*.

Mechanical Hooks SB Menu

Key Dice Rolls

tem **Charter Reading:** Wits+Lore (DV 34); +1 die with *witness gaps*. tem **Banner Law Parley:** Presence+Sway (DV 4); *Article Cite* grants Position +1. tem **Village Negotiation:** Diplomacy or Broker (DV 34). tem **False Evidence:** Subterfuge+Lore (DV 45) after the miniscore setup. tem **Supply Cut/Restore:** Tactics+Streetwise or Engineering (DV 34).

Story Beats (Keeper Spend)

tem **False Orders** (colors cross at the ford) tem **Ally Turns** (shamed officer flips)
tem **Cut Supply Lines** (granary cordon tightens) tem **CampFever** (restless troops)
tem **Gear Failure** (*mantlet collapse; wedgesnap rockfall*) tem **Authority Intervention**
(lord's reeve arrives) tem **Winter Omens** (first frost early)

Outcomes Reputation

Success

tem **Clean Victory:** Both withdraw honorintact; PCs gain *Broker's Favor* with both.
tem **Pragmatic:** One stays as protector on narrowed charter; PCs gain a *Village String*
(ford free). tem **Innovative:** Synthesis adopted; PCs tagged as *banner mediators*.

Failure

tem **Village Lost:** Saltmere destroyed; PCs earn a *Black Mark*. tem **Banner War:**
Companies clash; *Skirmish Spiral* [6] begins. tem **Patron Wrath:** *Political Pressure* [4]
follows the party.

GM Aids

When you want to... (Order guidance)

tem **Cool things down:** Call *Bell Dawn Parley* (push Position to Controlled). tem
Reroute a company: Run *False Orders* (threaten Cohesion). tem **Bind with paper:**
Use *Charter Synthesis Workshop*. tem **Make it tactile:** Trigger the *Forgery MiniScore*.

Quick Reference: Scene DVs

lll rule	Scene	Primary Test	DV	/ Notes
rule	Charter Reading	Wits+Lore	34;	+1 die if <i>witness gaps</i> noted
Bell Dawn Parley	Presence+Sway	4;	Position	+1 if Article Cite + evidence
Forgery	Materials	Craft/Subterfuge	3;	sets later Watermark Test
Forgery	Language	Lore+Wits	4;	avoid anachronism
Forgery	Witness Seal	Diplomacy+Presence	3;	risk <i>Rumor</i> [2]
Forgery	Delivery	Subterfuge/Performance	45;	on hit, Withdraw 1 Ring or Cohesion +1
Deescalate Spiral	Command+Tactics	4;	clear 1 from	<i>Skirmish Spiral</i>
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